



**Air University - Aerospace and Aviation Campus,
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The Pillars of Islaam / Arkan ul Islam
(Importance of Salah)

Five Pillars of Islam:

- Pillars of the Islam are five basic acts in Islam, considered obligatory by Muslims. These are summarized in the famous Hadith of Gabriel. The Qur'an presents them as a framework for worship and a sign of commitment to the faith. They are

1. The Shahadah (Testimony)
2. Salah (Prayer)
3. Sawm (Fasting during Ramadan)
4. Zakah (Alms giving) and
5. Hajj (Pilgrimage to Mecca) at least once in a lifetime.

Salah:

- *Shahadah* (شهادة) is a saying professing monotheism and accepting Muhammad as God's messenger. The *shahadah* is a set statement normally recited in Arabic:

أشهد أن لا إله إلا الله وأشهد أن محمدا رسول الله

- *I profess that there is no god but Allah and I profess that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.* When a person wishes to convert religions they should recite this affirmation and believe in it.

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- ***Salah:***

- *Salah* is the Islamic prayer. *Salah* consists of five daily prayers. All of these prayers are recited while facing the *Ka'bah* in Mecca. Muslims must wash themselves before prayer, this washing is called *Wudu*. The prayer is accompanied by a series of set positions including; bowing with hands on knees, standing, prostrating and sitting in a special position (not on the heels, nor on the buttocks, with the toes pointing away from Mecca), usually with one foot tucked under the body.

Definition of the word Salah

- *Linguistic Definition*: Du'aa or supplication
- *Technical Definition*: Type of worship consisting of specific statements and actions. It begins by pronouncing the greatness of Allah (Takbir) and ends with salutations of peace (Tasleem).

Importance of Salah:

- Salah is the most important pillar of Islam after the testimony of faith. The Prophet said, “The head of the matter is Islam, its pillar is the prayer, and the top of its hump is Jihad in the way of Allah.” [Sahih Muslim]
- Prayer was the first act of worship made obligatory by Allah. Its obligation was revealed directly to the Prophet during his ascension to heaven. Anas said, “The prayers were made obligatory on the Prophet the night of his ascension to heaven. At first they were fifty in number, but were reduced several times until they were five. Then it was proclaimed, ‘O Mohammed, the order is not changed. These five are (equivalent to) the fifty.’” [Sunan Tirmidhi]

Importance of Salah:

- Prayer is the first act that we will be accountable for Abdullah ibn Qart related that the Messenger of Allah said, “The first act that the slave will be accountable for on the Day of Judgment will be prayer. If it is good, then the rest of his acts will be good. And if it is evil, then the rest of his acts will be evil.” [Tabarani]
- Salah was the last thing the Prophet (SAW) recommended to his nation before he died “Prayer, prayer, and what your right hand possesses.” [Musnad Ahmad]
- The Prophet (peace be upon him), said: “Order your children to pray when they reach the age of seven and punish them for not performing it at the age of ten and separate them (ie. boys and girls) in their beds” (Sahih Bukhari).

One who ignores the Salah:

- Not praying and denying its obligation is seen as disbelief and places the person outside the fold of Islam. Jabir reports that the Prophet said, “Between a person and disbelief is discarding prayer.” [Sahih Muslim]. Abdullah ibn Amr ibn al-Aas reported that the Prophet one day mentioned the prayer and said, “Whoever guards and observes his prayer, they will be a light and a proof and a savior for him on the Day of Resurrection. Whoever does not guard and observe them, they will not be a light or a proof or a savior for him. On the Day of Resurrection, he will be with Qarun, Firaun, Haman and Ubayy ibn Khalf.” [Musnad Ahmad]

How to perform the prayer:

1. *Facing the Qiblah:*
2. *Intention:*
3. *The Opening Takbir:*
4. *Placing the right hand above the left hand:*
5. *Qiyam (Standing):*
6. *Reciting Fatihah and Quran:*
7. *Ruku (Bowing):*
8. *Qawma and Etidal (Straightening up):*
9. *Sajdah (Prostration):*
10. *Jalsah (Sitting between two Sajdahs):*
11. *Sajdah (Prostration):*
12. *Tashahhud (Sitting):*
13. *Salam(Ending the Prayer):*

Salah Timings and Units:

- *FAJR* (Dawn) PRAYER: Its time begins at dawn when morning light first appears in the horizon and continues until the sun rises. (2 + **2**)
- *DHUHR* (Noon) PRAYER: Its time begins when the sun reaches its highest point in the sky and continues up to the time of Asr Prayer. (4 + **4** + 2)
- *ASR* (Afternoon) PRAYER: Its time begins when the shadow of an object is equal to its own length, plus the length of its noontime shadow and continues until sunset. (2/4 + **4**)

Salah Timings and Units:

- *MAGHRIB* (Sunset) PRAYER: Its time starts from sunset and continues until the end of twilight. Twilight is the redness which remains in the horizon after sunset. (3 + 2)
- *ISHA* (Evening) PRAYER: Its time starts when the twilight disappears and continues up to mid-night. Mid-night in this case may not necessarily be interpreted to mean 12:00 o'clock but may be construed as the mid-time between sunset and the appearance of the true dawn. (2/4 + 4 + 2 + 3)